KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4-5 · HOLIDAY BONUS · HOLIDAY CULTURE · OPTIONAL BONUS

Winter Celebrations and the Longest Night

Name: _____ **Date:** _____

PRE-LESSON WARM-UP · DO THIS BEFORE YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

What Do I Already Know?

Write what you know right now. Guesses are fine; this is your starting point.

1. What do you think causes the longest night of the year? Explain your guess.

2. Name two holidays celebrated in December or January. Write one thing you know about each.

3. Prediction: On December 21, is the day long or short in Australia? Why do you think so?

4. Sketch Earth and the Sun to show your idea of why winter happens. Label your sketch.

5. Write one question you have about winter celebrations or the solstice.

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POST-LESSON CHALLENGE · DO THIS AFTER YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

What Did I Learn?

Use evidence from today's lesson. Write in complete sentences.

1. Explain the December solstice for BOTH hemispheres. Use the words axial tilt and hemisphere.

2. Use two numbers from the daylight table to support this claim: latitude, not country, controls day length.

3. Choose two celebrations from today. Explain one similarity, one difference, and the calendar each one follows.

4. Interview someone in your family: What is one tradition our family has at this time of year? Where did it come from? Write what you learned and one follow-up question you asked.

★ **Challenge:** Record your town's sunrise and sunset for five days in a row. Make a table, calculate each day's daylight, and use your data to explain which hemisphere you live in.

Looking Ahead: Welcome back, and happy new year! Your next Pathways lessons pick up after the break. Lunar New Year arrives on February 6 in 2027, beginning the Year of the Goat. Bring a question: how does a lunisolar calendar decide when a new year begins?